banking facilities. The country needed a central bank and a great commercial bank.[20] This view was also endorsed by Cecil Kisch (later Sir), an authority on central banking, and Montagu Norman, Governor of the Bank of England, in their deposition before the Commission.

On the other hand, Purshotamdas believed that there should be no rival to the Imperial Bank and recommended the evolution of the central bank from the Imperial Bank. In his Minute of dissent, Purshotamdas had observed that 'the ends in view, for as far ahead as we can see will be better served by developing the Imperial Bank of India into a full-fledged central bank.'[21] In support of his stand, Purshotamdas cited the example of the Bank of France which was discharging both functions (i.e. central banking and commercial banking) successfully. (It is said that Sir James Taylor, the second Governor of the RBI was also in favour of mixed banking.) Purshotamdas remarked: 'No rival therefore should be allowed to impair the prestige and authority of the Imperial Bank of India, and no division of the Government funds between it and another institution should be permitted to restrict its capacity to open new, and even temporarily unprofitable branches which are essential to the mobilization of the resources of the country.'[22]



Drafting the Minute single-handedly had left Purshotamdas a very tired man. Mental exertion of a very high caliber, and the intensive research and investigation involved in putting forward a reasoned and effective justification of his views, had left him exhausted. Within the Commission his colleagues were less than sympathetic. Once Purshotamdas put on record his intention to submit a Minute of dissent, all attempts were made to dissuade the dissentient from his 'rebellious effort'. Two incidents, the first to inveigle, and the second to persuade, are worthy of mention.

When Purshotamdas had made his intentions clear on the minute, G.H. Baxter, one of the Secretaries of the Commission informed him that a subcommittee of Parliament had recommended that unless one-third of the members of the committee were of a certain opinion, no dissent could be admitted. As he (Purshotamdas) was in a minority of one, his dissent could not be admissible and his labours were likely to be in vain. When